

Gilbert Appiah

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Strategic Technical Leader and Architect with over 7 years of experience building, deploying, and scaling reliable production systems. Expert in Cloud Solution Architecture and Agentic DevOps, specialized in integrating AI-powered tools into the enterprise SDLC to drive developer productivity and operational excellence.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Microsoft

Aug 2025 – Present

Sr. Solution Engineer — Software, Development Tools & AI

- Architecting Agentic DevOps: Lead hands-on technical engagements, including PoCs and architecture workshops, to embed AI (GitHub Copilot, Azure Developer Tools) into customer SDLCs.
- Enterprise AI Strategy: Serve as a trusted advisor to engineering leaders, designing secure, scalable, and AI-native development environments for global financial institutions.
- Production Reliability: Accelerate AI integration while ensuring systemic stability, transitioning legacy workflows into modern, AI-first development stacks.
- Cross-Functional Influence: Partner with Product Engineering to influence roadmaps based on enterprise-scale adoption challenges and successes.

Microsoft

Mar 2022 – Aug 2025

Sr. Cloud Solution Architect

- Cloud Solution Architecture: Designed and implemented cloud-native applications for S500 customers using microservices and containerization (Docker, Azure Compute, Kubernetes).
- Customer Enablement: Engaged with customers, partners, and account teams to understand business needs and design solutions leveraging Microsoft Cloud.
- Production Excellence: Maintained a 98% resolution rate within SLA for critical customer workloads, ensuring high availability and reliability.
- Efficiency at Scale: Optimized Azure code deployments and service configurations, resulting in a 40% reduction in deployment time.
- Technical Evangelism: Conducted 100+ workshops and custom deliveries to enhance customer technical maturity, driving increased Azure consumption across organizations.
- Leadership: Delivered several multi-million dollar engineering and support contracts for proactive/reactive engagements.

Microsoft

Jun 2020 – Mar 2022

Azure App Service Escalation Engineer

- Critical Systems Support: Resolved 200+ high-severity production issues with a 98% customer satisfaction rate.
- Deployment Optimization: Assisted customers with complex code deployments to Azure, reducing deployment-related failures by 25%.
- Container Engineering: Configured customer applications to run on containers, enhancing application scalability and portability.
- Team Leadership: Mentored colleagues on deep-tier troubleshooting, improving team-wide resolution times by 30%.

Ally Financial (via Cognizant)

May 2019 – Jun 2020

Architect / Full-Stack Developer

- Feature Delivery: Designed and prototyped client features and major initiatives on-site, improving feature delivery time by 25%.
- Production Reliability: Owned Identity Management services for the client's application, ensuring 99.9% uptime.
- Secure API Design: Built resilient REST APIs using Java, Spring Boot, Spring Security, OAuth, and JWT.
- CI/CD Engineering: Implemented Jenkins pipelines for primary CI/CD, reducing deployment errors by 30%.
- Serverless Architecture: Created serverless Lambda functions and JWT authorizers, enhancing system scalability.

Regulur Inc

May 2018 – Jan 2019

iOS Developer

- Simplified application codebase by refactoring and minimizing storyboard usage, reducing code complexity by 40%.
- Implemented multi-threaded processes with memory management, resulting in 20% performance improvements.
- Built with Swift, Xcode, and CodeIgniter backend; deployed first version to the iOS App Store.

US Naval Undersea Warfare Center

Sep 2017 – May 2018

Software Engineer

- Designed a Windows OS system to synchronize MIDI and audio devices for theatrical productions using C# and XAML.
- Built a theatrical lighting management system achieving zero defects during development.
- Ensured quality via Visual Studio MSTest; utilized agile and scrum methodologies throughout the development lifecycle.

Teplr

Jul 2015 – Dec 2017

Co-Founder / Full Stack Developer

- Founded a social media app and led a team of 4 developers, achieving 1,000 sign-ups for test flight.
- Managed private server setup, RESTful API development, and CI/CD deployment pipeline.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Architecture & Strategy: Cloud Solution Architecture, Microservices, System Design, Context Engineering, AI Governance

AI & Automation: GitHub Copilot (CLI & IDE), Azure AI Foundry, Agentic DevOps, Prompt Engineering, MCP Servers

Cloud & DevOps: GitHub, Azure DevOps, Azure (App Service, Functions, Logic Apps), AWS (Lambda, S3), CI/CD (GitHub Actions, ADO, Jenkins), Docker, Kubernetes

Full-Stack Engineering: C#/.NET, Java (Spring Boot), Python, JavaScript/Node.js, React.js, Swift, Django REST Framework, TDD, SDD, REST

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — University of Massachusetts at Dartmouth

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Developer Associate (AZ-204)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Azure App Service Development (Nov 2020)
- Azure App Service OSS (Sep 2020)

AWARDS

- Microsoft Global Hackathon 2023 — Winner